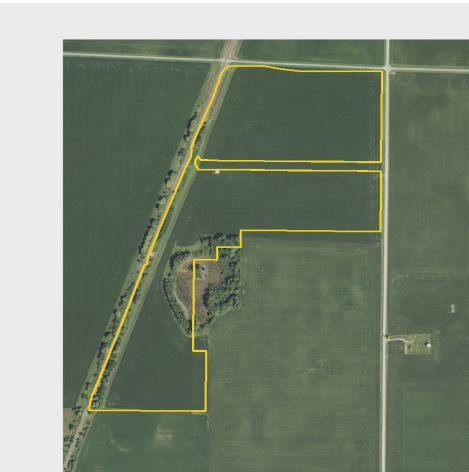


Field CHA-036

57 acres in Champaign County, Illinois. What the satellite record shows for the 2026 season.

Prepared Oct 6, 2026
Imagery through Oct 2, 2026
Field Record (working name)



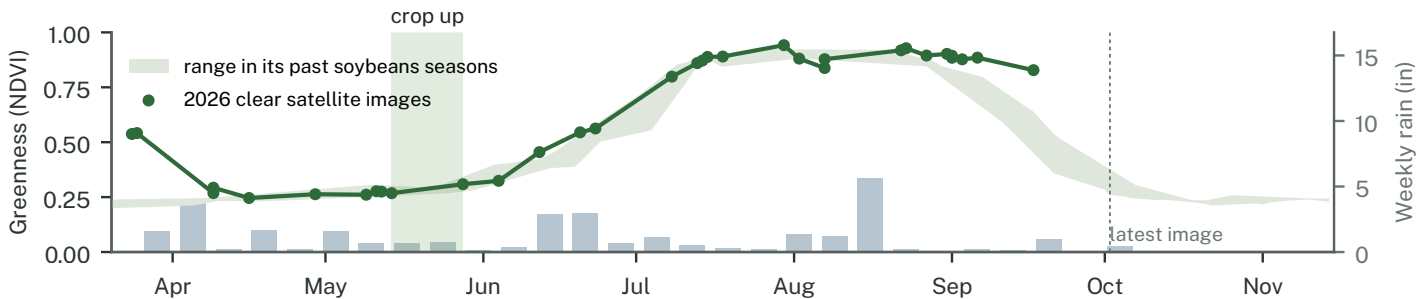
USDA NAIP aerial photo, 2023. Field boundary in yellow.

2026 crop	Soybeans (high confidence)
Crop came up	between May 14 and May 28, so likely planted Apr 30 to May 21
Harvest	crop still green in the last clear image (Sep 17)
After the 2025 harvest	No tillage seen (residue stayed on the surface)
Winter 2025-26	Cover crop seen (4 of 10 clear winter images green)
Season greenness	1st greenest of its 4 soybeans seasons since 2020; 67th percentile of 1,753 Champaign County soybeans fields

2019 Corn	2020 Soybeans	2021 Corn	2022 Soybeans	2023 Corn	2024 Soybeans	2025 Corn	2026 Soybeans
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Crop by year: USDA Cropland Data Layer 2019-2025; 2026 from our model.

The 2026 season

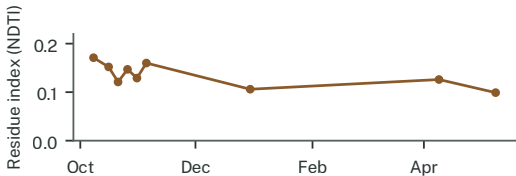


After the 2025 harvest



Sep 26, 2025, Sentinel-2 (after harvest)

Jan 4, 2026, Sentinel-2 (cover crop green)



Worth a look

Nothing inside the boundary stood out in the last four seasons: no persistent low spots, no hot spots, no change in land use.

This field is in soybeans for 2026, and the crop was up by May 28. Harvest has not shown up in the imagery yet; the latest clear image is from Sep 17. Through the summer it stayed ahead of most soybeans fields in the county (67th percentile on greenness), which tracks crop vigor but is not a yield estimate. After last year's harvest the residue stayed on the surface and a winter cover crop came up, and nothing inside the boundary stood out as a problem area.

Evidence. Dates above rest on these satellite scenes: May 14 2026, crop up (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); May 28 2026, crop up (Landsat 8 path/row 022032); Jul 30 2026, peak (Landsat 9 path/row 023032); Sep 17 2026, dry-down, harvest (Landsat 8 path/row 022032). The chart and winter checks use 78 clear images from Aug 2025 on, all listed in the field record file.

How it was made. Greenness is NDVI and the residue index is NDTI, averaged 10 m inside the boundary (USDA NASS Crop Sequence Boundaries). Crop up is when greenness first passed 0.30; planting is estimated 1-2 weeks earlier. Hot spots use Landsat 8/9 surface temperature. Season greenness tracks crop vigor and is not a yield estimate.